

INDIA PICTURE



1. Kishore Kumar, Asha Bhosle and R.D. Burman

2. Mohammed Rafi

3. Lata Mangeshkar in concert

How do you encompass the musical journey of a culture in 1,000 words? The sheer magnitude of Indian music is overwhelming, instrumental as it has been in reflecting our society's hopes and feelings. Indeed, it has been the purest form of unadulterated glee and lasting melancholia.

Let's start with the now. If there is someone who understands the global impact of music, it's Karan Johar. Not since Rahman's *Slumdog Millionaire* has a soundtrack, or in the case of *Brahmastra*, the song '***Kesariya***', made such an impact on the global music charts. It's a no-brainer that this legacy of hit soundtracks will continue with *Rocky and Rani ki Prem Kahani*.

Speaking of legacies, post-pandemic, Sanjay Leela Bhansali's *Gangubai Kathiawadi* set the standard on what to expect in larger-than-life musical scores. '***Dholida***' was an instant hit showcasing the vibrant Alia Bhatt in all her glory. Singer Jahnvi Shrimankar outdoes herself in this blend of Hindi and Gujarati cultures.

The past decade saw some excruciatingly confusing times, but it had its moments. Throwback to 2013, and it's now 10 years since Arijit Singh enthralled us with '***Tum hi ho***', showing the audience how a voice could evoke a plethora of emotions. A beautifully crafted song by the genius Mithoon, who wrote and composed the song. Arijit has been a revelation, from '*Tum hi ho*' to '*Kesariya*', he has probably created some important musical touchstones for this generation.

The boom of smartphones in the early 2000s ushered the way for India's very first viral song, '***Why this kolaveri di***'. '***Emosanal attyachar***' became the love anthem of a brokenhearted generation while winning a national award at the same time. And Hrithik Roshan took the mantle from SRK to become India's heartthrob with *Kaho Naa...Pyaar Hai* with its euphoric and melancholic tunes. The title song, sung by Alka Yagnik and Udit Narayan and brilliantly composed by Rajesh Roshan, is played at parties even today after two decades.

For a millennial like me, the '90s are like a warm hug. From Indipop icon Alisha Chinai finding her perfect groom ('***Made in India***') to Lucky Ali's '***O Sanam***', Vishal Bhardwaj's '***Jungle jungle baat chali hai***' waking us up every Sunday